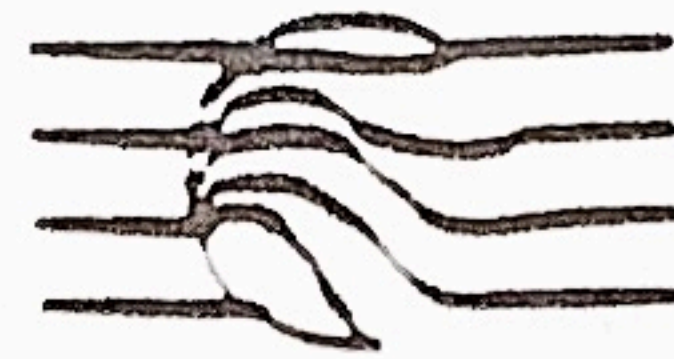




NATIONS UNIES
UNITED NATIONS



IDNDR
1990-2000

Décennie internationale de la prévention des catastrophes naturelles
International Decade for Natural Disaster Reduction

REF: NDR 400

11 January 1994

Dear NGO Colleague,

I am writing to inform you about the goals and activities of the **International Decade for Natural Disaster Reduction (IDNDR)** and to challenge you to consider the ways the Decade could serve as a fruitful framework for action of your organization.

Despite international relief efforts, the growing number of natural disasters continue to result in grave human suffering, economic losses and physical damage. Special emphasis should therefore be given to prevent and to minimize the harmful impacts of different natural disasters worldwide and especially in the most vulnerable developing countries.

The IDNDR was launched by a General Assembly resolution adopted in December 1989 with the objective of reducing through concerted international action, especially in developing countries, the loss of life, property damage and economic and social disruption caused by natural disasters.

The IDNDR Secretariat is part of the United Nations Department of Humanitarian Affairs based in Geneva. The National IDNDR Committees and Focal Points worldwide are important actors in the promotion and implementation of the principles of natural disaster reduction at national level.

Nevertheless, much more effort is needed at the local, national and international level to ensure that enough emphasis is given to disaster reduction activities. The active participation of the international, regional and local non-governmental organizations working within the fields of development, emergency relief, environment, appropriate technology, social mobilization and training is of major importance to make our world safer for the 21st Century.

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